

Technical Note

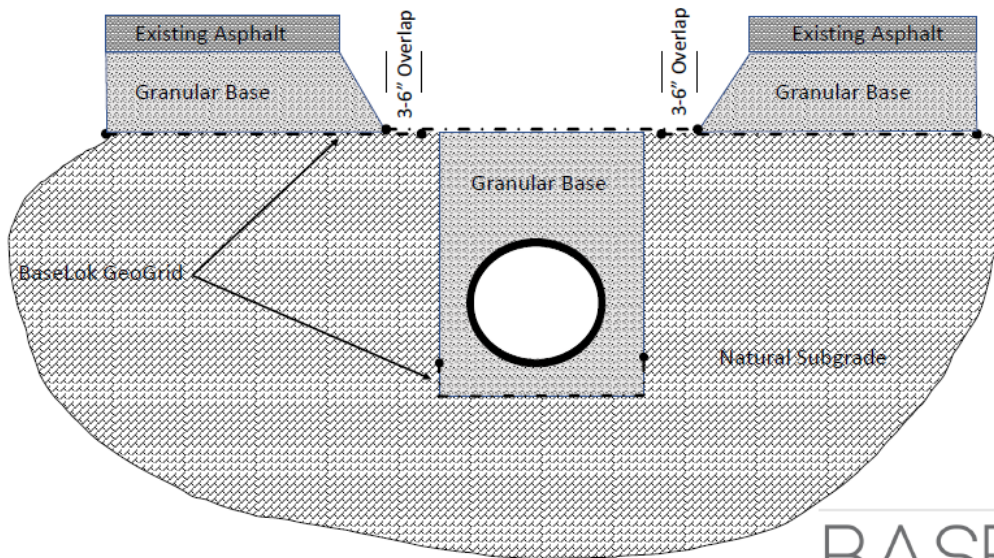
Subject – Trench Repair when trenching through BaseLok® Geogrid

Industrial Fabrics, Inc. (IFI) manufactures the BaseLok® line of geosynthetics in Houston, TX. Our products include geogrid, geocell, and laminated geogrid called FabGrid®. Questions often arise regarding what happens when trenching or drilling through our geogrid products. BaseLok® Geogrid products are punched and drawn geogrids manufactured from polypropylene sheets. The process of punching and drawing the geogrids align the polymers increasing the tensile modulus of the geogrid. Our geogrid products typically break at approximately 13-15% strain. The ability to reach the ultimate tensile strength at these low strains allows for trenching, drilling, etc. through the geogrid. When a piece of equipment encounters the geogrid, the geogrid will slightly elongate, then break, allowing the tool to pass through. Below is a picture of BaseLok® geogrid that was recently drilled through that shows this.



Notice that the grid simply shears off and the surrounding soil hasn't been overly disturbed. If the area needs to be repaired, such as in a utility trench application, follow the detail below.

TRENCH REPAIR DETAIL



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There are no concerns trenching or drilling through BaseLok[®] Geogrid. Please reach out to the BaseLok[®] Engineering team for further questions.